

## Picture this . . .

You've spent the entire weekend helping your 18-year-old pack up their bedroom and box up their belongings.

Finally the moment has arrived to say goodbye.

You walk them to the front door and give them a hug.

You've known this was coming for weeks, but your stomach is still in knots.

It's a pivotal moment in both your lives.

But this time something's different.

You know you've prepared them for anything they could possibly face.

And even if something happens to you, they're going to be okay.

You may not have given them a trust fund, but you've given them something even more valuable: wisdom and real life experiences.

As they walk out the door, they smile at you.

They jump in their car, reverse out of the driveway, give you a *toot, toot*, a wave, and then they're . . .

Gone.

You close the door, go back inside.

You sit down on the couch and a wave of emotion hits you.

Then . . . you smile.

You take a deep breath and think to yourself: